

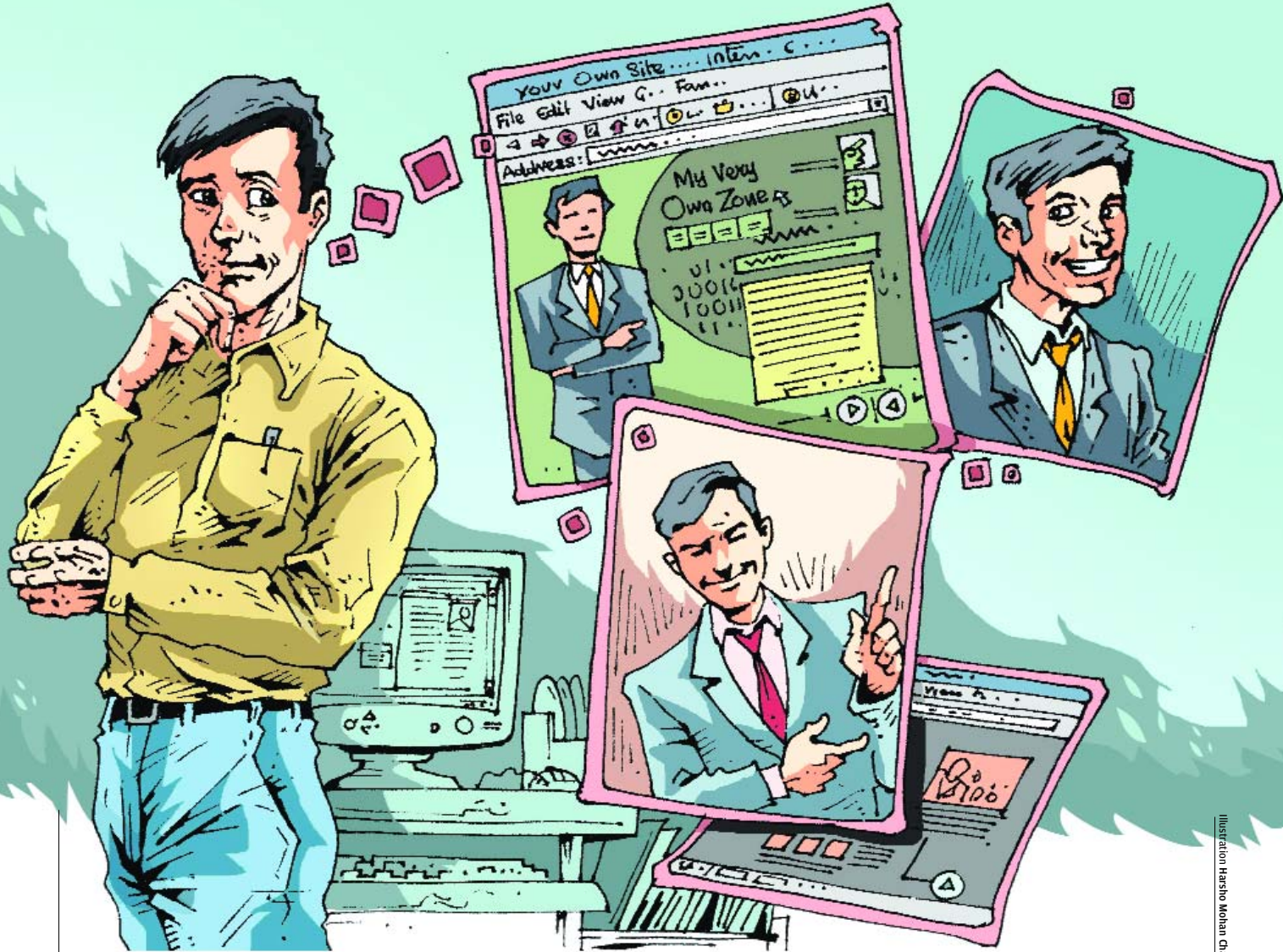


Illustration: Harsho Mohan Chatterji

www.mybusiness.com

Set up a professional looking Web site for a little over Rs 400 a Year

Robert Sovereign-Smith

One thousand crores, or one lakh; 15,000 employees, or 15; global or limited to one city—no matter what your business turnover, employee strength or area coverage is, you need a Web site.

Yes, there are still those running family businesses who will claim that it's the personal touch that matters; but if you're here, reading this article, you know the advantages the WWW has to offer.

It's a simple matter of information, and if you don't have a Web site for your business yet, it's time you host one. Today, when we hear a company name, we immediately attempt to visit its Web site to find out more about it. If we don't have its Web

address, we immediately get on to Google and search for the company name.

If we don't find it within the first five minutes, we give up and decide that if Google, the *baap* of all search engines, can't find it, it isn't worth our time anyway. This is sad, and a perception that may be totally wrong in your opinion, but it is the cold harsh truth of today.

You might have thought of setting up your own little Web site. Perhaps, you do own a free Web site, which is too bland to draw attention to, leave alone publicise it.

The thought that stopped you in your tracks was, "A Web site will cost thousands a month on server maintenance and site development."

Well, you are wrong! You can set one up for just Rs 400 a year!

The Dot-Com Domain

The first thing you need is a domain name. This is your own little postbox on the Web. You will obviously buy a domain that has your business' name in it, and set your eyes on buying a .com—unless you run a non-profit organization (.org), or are interested in setting up a .info, .biz, or a .name Web site. Let's stick with .com domains in this article, mainly because a majority of the online world associates Web sites with a .com.

Let's say you want to purchase **TheSiteYouWantToBuy.com**. You need to log onto a registrar's site and check for its availability. If you have a credit card, we suggest **www.godaddy.com**—they are reliable and have really low rates. The entire list of ICANN (Internet Corporation for Assigned Names and Numbers) accredited regis-